

Tutorial 2

Building a Daily Market Briefing Routine

A student-ready workflow for turning morning news into a repeatable pre-market plan.

Module purpose

Prepared from the April 21, 2026 class transcript. Original discussion anchor: Val used Perplexity for morning business news, while the lesson expanded into Asian market reaction, U.S. session personalities, power hour, daily reports, weekly reports, and news hygiene. Educational material only - not investment advice.

Ideal length	Audience	Student output
60-75 minutes	Beginner market students	One-page morning brief + catalyst calendar

Version: 2026-04-21 | Source-backed instructor draft

1. Lesson snapshot

What the live conversation was really about

The student already had a useful instinct: ask an AI tool for business news at the start of the day. The tutorial turns that instinct into a disciplined routine: calendar first, global markets second, catalysts third, chart levels fourth, then a written plan.

The main upgrade is to stop treating news as a random feed. A market briefing should separate scheduled events from surprise headlines, global session reaction from U.S. regular-session price action, and useful signal from noise. The result should be a written decision map, not a feeling.

Conversation idea	Student version	Why it matters
Ask Perplexity for business news.	Ask AI for news, but require official sources, timestamps, and a distinction between scheduled events and unscheduled headlines.	AI is a research assistant, not a trading signal. Students must verify the calendar and source.
Look at Asia before the U.S. session.	Check Asia, Europe, futures, rates, dollar, commodities, and major sector catalysts before U.S. open.	Global markets often show how risk appetite carried through overnight.
Each session has a personality.	Track premarket, opening drive, midday, and final-hour behavior separately.	The same chart pattern can mean different things at 9:35 a.m. and 3:30 p.m. ET.

2. Learning objectives

- Build a morning market brief without drowning in information.
- Use official calendars for scheduled catalysts such as CPI, jobs, FOMC, GDP, PCE, Treasury auctions, and energy reports.
- Explain why overnight futures and international markets matter, while still respecting U.S. regular-session liquidity.
- Separate headline interpretation from trade execution.
- Finish each briefing with clear levels, scenarios, and rules for when not to trade.

3. The daily briefing sequence

Use the same order every day. The routine should be short enough to repeat and strict enough to prevent emotional trading. Students can add depth over time, but the first goal is consistency.

Step	Question	Student action	Output
1. Calendar	What is scheduled today?	Check Fed, BLS, BEA, Treasury, EIA, earnings calendar.	List time, release, asset most affected.
2. Overnight	How did global risk trade?	Check Asia, Europe, equity futures, dollar, yields, oil, gold.	Risk-on, risk-off, mixed, or quiet.
3. Headlines	What changed since yesterday close?	Summarize only market-moving headlines with timestamps.	Bullish, bearish, or uncertain catalyst list.
4. Levels	Where can price prove or disprove the idea?	Mark prior high/low, overnight range, VWAP, key support/resistance.	Two upside levels and two downside levels.

Step	Question	Student action	Output
5. Scenarios	What will I do if price confirms?	Write if/then plans before the open.	Plan A, Plan B, invalidation, no-trade rule.

4. Market clocks and session personality

A briefing routine starts with the clock. U.S. stocks have regular trading hours, while futures trade much longer. That difference matters because futures can react overnight, but U.S. cash-session liquidity and execution quality are different.

Market clock	What to teach	Source anchor
U.S. regular session	NYSE regular trading runs from 9:30 a.m. to 4:00 p.m. Eastern Time on normal trading days.	NYSE hours and holiday calendar. [1]
Index futures	E-mini S&P; 500 futures trade on CME Globex from Sunday evening through Friday afternoon, with daily pauses.	CME E-mini S&P; 500 contract page. [2]
Extended hours	Premarket and after-hours moves can matter, but they come with lower liquidity, volatility, uncertain prices, and wider spreads.	Investor.gov extended-hours bulletin. [3]

Teaching phrase

Futures can set the overnight map; the cash session decides whether real liquidity confirms it. Do not treat a thin premarket print as the same quality of evidence as a regular-session breakout.

5. Scheduled catalysts: build the calendar before reading opinions

Students should learn that many large moves are not mysterious. They cluster around known events. The first pass of a morning brief should identify what is scheduled before reading commentary about what might happen.

Catalyst	Why it matters	Where to verify
FOMC	Rates, dollar, yields, equities, gold, and risk appetite can reprice around decisions, minutes, and projections.	Federal Reserve calendar. [4]
Jobs, CPI, PPI, JOLTS	Labor and inflation data affect rate expectations and sector leadership.	BLS release calendar. [5]
GDP, PCE, personal income	Growth and inflation data affect macro regime, rates, and consumer sectors.	BEA release schedule. [6]
Oil inventories	Important for energy, inflation expectations, airlines, transports, and commodities.	EIA weekly petroleum schedule. [7]
Treasury auctions	Auction demand can influence yields, duration-sensitive equities, banks, and the dollar.	Treasury auction schedule. [8]

6. The 10-minute morning brief template

This template is designed for repetition. Students should fill it out before looking for trades. The purpose is to force clarity and reduce the urge to chase headlines.

Box	Prompt	Student notes
Calendar	What is scheduled today and at what exact time?	
Overnight	How did Asia, Europe, futures, rates, dollar, oil, and gold behave?	
Headlines	What changed since yesterday close? Cite timestamp and source.	
Asset focus	Which market or ticker is worth watching, and why?	
Levels	What levels prove strength, weakness, or no-trade?	
Plan	If/then plan, invalidation, risk limit, and when to stop.	

7. AI prompt for the morning routine

Copy/paste prompt

Prompt: Build my pre-market briefing for today. First list scheduled catalysts with official source links and release times in Eastern Time. Then summarize overnight Asia, Europe, U.S. futures, rates, dollar, oil, and gold. Then list market-moving headlines with timestamps. Separate facts from interpretation. End with three scenarios: bullish, bearish, and no-trade. Do not recommend a trade.

Students can ask follow-up questions in simple English or another language, but the output must still end in a written plan with sources. The AI can speed up collection; it cannot replace judgment.

8. Common beginner errors

Error	Correction
Reading opinions before checking the calendar.	Start with scheduled catalysts. Opinions come later.
Treating every headline as tradable.	Ask whether the headline changes earnings, rates, liquidity, policy, or positioning.
Trading premarket prints like regular-session confirmation.	Respect liquidity, spreads, and execution risk in extended hours. [3]
Not writing invalidation.	Every plan needs a point where the idea is wrong.

9. Classroom exercise and rubric

Student assignment

Students complete the 10-minute brief for one trading day, then compare it with the actual session. Grade the process, not the profit. Did they identify the calendar? Did they separate facts from opinion? Did they write levels and invalidation before the move?

Skill	Excellent	Needs work
Calendar discipline	Uses official calendars and exact times.	Relies on social media or memory.

Skill	Excellent	Needs work
Signal filtering	Separates scheduled catalysts, headlines, and commentary.	Treats all news as equal.
Execution readiness	Has levels, scenarios, risk limit, and no-trade rule.	Only says bullish or bearish.

10. Source-backed reading list

Use these as the external reading pack. For this routine, official calendars and official market-hours pages are more important than commentary.

[1] [NYSE - Holidays and Trading Hours](#). Official NYSE market-hours and holiday-calendar source; U.S. equity regular session is 9:30 a.m. to 4:00 p.m. Eastern Time.

[2] [CME Group - E-mini S&P 500 futures overview](#). CME lists Globex trading for E-mini S&P 500 futures from Sunday 6:00 p.m. to Friday 5:00 p.m. Eastern Time, with daily maintenance pauses.

[3] [Investor.gov - Extended-Hours Trading Investor Bulletin](#). SEC Investor.gov explains risks of extended-hours trading, including lower liquidity, price volatility, uncertain prices, unlinked markets, and wider quote spreads.

[4] [Federal Reserve - FOMC calendars and information](#). Official calendar for FOMC meetings, statements, minutes, and meetings associated with Summary of Economic Projections.

[5] [BLS - Schedule of Selected Releases 2026](#). Official release calendar for market-moving labor and inflation data such as Employment Situation, CPI, PPI, and JOLTS.

[6] [BEA - Release Schedule](#). Official release schedule for GDP, Personal Income and Outlays, PCE, trade, and corporate profits.

[7] [EIA - Weekly Petroleum Status Report schedule](#). EIA states the standard release time for the Weekly Petroleum Status Report is 10:30 a.m. Eastern Time on Wednesdays, with holiday exceptions.

[8] [U.S. Treasury - Tentative Auction Schedule](#). Official Treasury auction calendar for bills, notes, bonds, TIPS, FRNs, announcement dates, auction dates, and settlement dates.

Instructor reminder

The goal is not to predict every move. The goal is to show up prepared, understand what matters today, and know when not to trade.